BENTONVILLE, ARKANSAS

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Vision Document

407–409 SE F St — SE Market District

February 2026

Confidential

Vision Document — Bentonville Wellness Center

> *A comprehensive wellness destination at 407-409 SE F St, downtown Bentonville, AR. Four founders. One thesis. The most undersupplied premium wellness market in America.*

The Thesis

Bentonville has assembled every ingredient for a world-class wellness market — except the product.

The demographic foundation is set. $112K median household income. A vendor ecosystem that relocates thousands of coastal professionals annually. A population that skews young, educated, and health-conscious. Spending patterns that already support premium dining, boutique retail, and curated experiences.

The cultural infrastructure exists. Crystal Bridges proved Bentonville could be a national cultural destination. The Momentary brought contemporary art and performance. The Walton Family Foundation poured $100M+ into trails that made NWA synonymous with outdoor recreation. Alice Walton's School of Medicine and the Whole Health Institute are anchoring Bentonville as a health innovation hub.

The real estate catalyst is here. The SE Market District is Bentonville's highest-conviction development corridor. 8th Street Market, The Momentary, Town Branch residential, and the 2028 Ice House redevelopment are creating a walkable destination neighborhood. But the neighborhood is missing its anchor wellness experience.

The market gap is structural, not accidental. Bentonville's existing wellness options are either clinical (SALT Health), single-modality (BlakeSt., C-Suites), corporate-closed (Walton Life), or commodity fitness (chain gyms). No facility integrates movement, recovery, nutrition, community, and content under one roof. No concept matches the city's economic positioning with a world-class wellness product.

The timing is now. The Ice House redevelopment (2028) and SE Market District investment create a once-in-a-generation window. The global wellness economy is $6.8T growing to $10T by 2029.

Contrast therapy has crossed from biohacker niche to mainstream adoption. Recovery-focused wellness is the fastest-growing segment. Bentonville's premium market is ready — the product isn't.

Our thesis: Build the wellness anchor that completes the SE Market District ecosystem. A destination that doesn't just serve the neighborhood — it elevates property values for the entire block.

The Experience

What It Feels Like

You arrive by bike on the Razorback Greenway, locking up in the generous bike parking that faces the trail. Or you walk from 8th Street Market, cutting through the garden courtyard where native Ozark plantings frame views of the limestone-and-timber building.

You enter at ground level. The reception area is warm — mass timber overhead, local stone underfoot, daylight filtering through the canopy of the upper levels above. The nutrition bar is alive with fresh produce from Tuckaway Farm and Turnbuckle. You can grab a cold-pressed juice without a membership — the storefront is public-facing, connected to the street.

Past reception, the strength floor opens up. This isn't an industrial gym. Equipment is integrated into the architecture — clean, minimal, premium. The climbing wall rises through the original warehouse height, 25 feet of textured surface that serves as both training and dramatic visual anchor. Functional movement mats occupy flexible space where martial arts, Ido Portal-style movement, and primal flow classes happen. Studio rooms host hot yoga, mat Pilates, breathwork.

Then you descend.

The staircase narrows. Stone walls close in. Light dims. Temperature shifts. You are entering the cave.

Underground — "The Cave." This is the heart of the building. A 40+ person communal sauna with multi-tier seating, faced in cedar. Cold plunges — multiple stations at varying temperatures. A steam room thick with eucalyptus. Mineral baths — warm soak pools evoking the Ozark spring tradition. Riverstone floors. Dim atmospheric lighting that makes the stone walls glow. Abundant showers and wet rooms.

This is a cell-phone-free zone. You are in the earth now. The only sounds are breath, water, and the low hum of heat.

After an hour of contrast therapy — hot, cold, hot, cold, rest — you ascend.

The building lightens as you climb. Timber gives way to glass. Stone gives way to plants. You enter the canopy.

Upper Level — "The Canopy." Greenhouse-like glass walls. Living plant walls. Filtered natural light. This is the intellectual and creative layer. The library holds a curated collection on health, wellbeing, philosophy, and science — reading nooks, chess tables, quiet zones. The media production studio is sound-isolated but visually stunning — the space IS the set, designed to produce nationally-reaching content. Meeting rooms and cowork nooks serve the community. Small exam rooms offer PT and practitioner services.

Rooftop — "The Sky." You emerge onto the outdoor lounge. Ozark hills stretch to the horizon. A grass strip hosts outdoor yoga. The rooftop garden echoes the one planned next door at the Ice House. This is where the journey completes — from cave below to sky above. Earth to light. Grounded to expansive.

This is the experience. Not a gym. Not a spa. Not a clinic. A complete wellness journey encoded in architecture.

Space Program

Underground — "The Cave"

Function: Contrast therapy core and deep recovery

SPACE	DESCRIPTION	CAPACITY
Communal sauna	Multi-tier cedar seating, atmospheric lighting	40+ persons
Cold plunges	Multiple stations, varying temperatures (45°F, 55°F)	8-12 simultaneous
Steam room	Eucalyptus-infused, stone-lined	15-20 persons
Mineral baths	Warm mineral soak pools	10-15 persons
Wet rooms / showers	Abundant, high-quality fixtures	20+ stations
Changing facilities	Lockers, vanities, grooming	Full capacity

Design language: Cave-like. Stone walls, earth tones, riverstone floors, dim atmospheric lighting. Reference: Blue Lagoon Retreat (Basalt Architects), Othership Toronto. **Cell-phone-free zone.**

Ground Level — “The Foundation”

Function: Movement, training, nutrition, community entry point

SPACE	DESCRIPTION	CAPACITY
Strength floor	Premium equipment integrated into architecture	30-40 simultaneous
Functional movement / martial arts mat	Open flexible space	20-30 persons
Studio rooms (2-3)	Hot yoga, mat Pilates, breathwork, group classes	20-30 each
Hot studio (1)	Small enclosed, very dim, intimate (Yoga Tropics reference)	20-25 persons
Nutrition bar	Fresh ingredients, CSA popup (Tuckaway, Turnbuckle farms)	Counter + seating
Reception / community gathering	Welcome, check-in, informal gathering	Open layout
Rock climbing wall	Uses original warehouse vertical height (25-30ft)	4-6 climbers

Design language: Warmer than underground. Timber and stone. Natural light beginning to enter. Connection to outdoor courtyard.

Upper Level(s) — “The Canopy”

Function: Mind, media, learning, community

SPACE	DESCRIPTION	CAPACITY
Media production studio	Sound-isolated, podcast + video, visually stunning	2-4 persons + crew
Library / sound lounge	Health, wellbeing, philosophy, science. Reading nooks, chess, games	20-30 persons
Meeting / event space	Talks, lectures, community gatherings	40-60 persons
Cowork nooks	Small, informal work zones (not a full coworking space)	6-10 persons
Exam / PT rooms (2)	Small enclosed rooms for practitioners	1-on-1

Design language: Airy, greenhouse-like. Glass walls, living plant walls, filtered natural light, abundant greenery. The “canopy” of the building.

Rooftop — “The Sky”

Function: Outdoor recovery, views, nature connection

SPACE	DESCRIPTION	CAPACITY
Outdoor lounge	Recovery seating, shade structures	20-30 persons
Rooftop garden	Edible + ornamental plantings	—
Grass strip	Outdoor yoga, stretching, movement	15-20 persons
Views	Panoramic Ozark hills + downtown Bentonville	—

Design language: Open sky. Bike-accessible. References BIG’s walkable roofs, Snohetta’s landscape extensions.

Exterior

SPACE	DESCRIPTION
Art court	Basketball/pickleball convertible, custom art design
Bike parking	Generous, trail-connected
Garden courtyard	Native Ozark plantings, connecting to Greenway + Momentary green space
Nutrition co-op storefront	Public-facing, no membership required

Nature Integration Philosophy

This building doesn’t sit in Bentonville — it grows from it.

Geological narrative. The vertical journey through the building mirrors the Ozark geological column: limestone caves below, hardwood forest canopy above, open sky at the peak. Every material choice reinforces this — Ozark limestone, local cedar, riverstone, mass timber.

Trail connection. The site’s adjacency to the Razorback Greenway isn’t incidental — it’s foundational. The building is designed as a destination on the trail, not separate from it. Cyclists and

runners approach from the Greenway and enter through the garden courtyard. The building is a waypoint, not a detour.

Living systems. Rooftop garden. Living plant walls. Native Ozark plantings at ground level. Rainwater collection. Permeable surfaces. The building participates in the natural water cycle rather than fighting it.

Outdoor-indoor continuity. The art court, garden courtyard, rooftop grass strip, and trail-facing nutrition bar ensure that the outdoor experience doesn't stop at the front door. The building has as much outdoor program as indoor.

Seasonal response. The contrast therapy core (underground) operates year-round regardless of weather. The rooftop and exterior spaces offer seasonal programming that responds to the Ozark climate — cool-weather fire features, warm-weather outdoor classes, spring/fall community events in the courtyard.

Content & Media Strategy

The Thesis: Media Subsidizes Membership

Most wellness centers are local businesses with local economics. This concept is different: the media production studio creates a national content brand that generates revenue independent of membership.

How It Works

The space IS the set. The building is designed to be visually stunning from every angle. The underground cave, the greenhouse canopy, the rooftop with Ozark views — every space is camera-ready. This isn't a studio bolted onto a gym. It's a wellness destination where content production is integrated into the architecture.

Content formats: - **Podcast studio:** Sound-isolated, premium production quality. Hosts health, wellness, philosophy conversations with national guests. - **Video production:** Recovery protocols, movement instruction, cooking/nutrition, practitioner interviews. Shot on location throughout the building. - **Social content:** The building's visual signature drives organic social reach. Cold plunge sessions in the cave. Sunrise yoga on the rooftop. Climbing on the warehouse wall. Every experience is inherently shareable.

Revenue streams from media: 1. **Brand sponsorships:** Wellness equipment brands, supplement companies, tech (wearables), food/nutrition brands pay to sponsor content produced in the space 2.

Affiliate/referral revenue: Products featured in content (equipment, supplements, wearables) generate affiliate income 3. **Content licensing:** Protocols, programs, and instructional content licensed to other facilities or digital platforms 4. **Equipment partnerships:** Premium equipment brands provide gear at reduced cost (or free) in exchange for visibility in content

Cipher relationship: Cipher (Jordan's digital health coaching brand) serves as a silent methodology partner. The wellness center's programming draws on Cipher's experiment-based, tool-agnostic, human-first framework — but the brands are independent. Cipher is not co-branded. This protects both brands and allows the wellness center to develop its own identity.

National Brand, Local Roots

The content strategy positions this space as a national voice in wellness — not just a Bentonville gym. Content reaches audiences far beyond NWA, building brand equity that: - Drives wellness tourism (day passes and destination visits) - Creates licensing opportunities for the programming methodology - Attracts national brand partnerships that subsidize local membership costs - Positions Bentonville itself as a wellness destination alongside its arts/outdoor identity

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Community Integration

Public vs. Member Spaces

Not everything requires a membership. Strategic public-facing elements create community connectivity:

PUBLIC (NO MEMBERSHIP)	MEMBER-ONLY
Nutrition bar / co-op storefront	Strength floor
Art court	Sauna / contrast therapy
Garden courtyard	Studios and classes
Community events (select)	Library / sound lounge
Rooftop garden (select hours)	Media studio

Local Farm Partnership

The nutrition bar serves as a **CSA (Community Supported Agriculture) popup** — partnering with local farms like Tuckaway Farm and Turnbuckle for fresh, seasonal produce, prepared foods, and

grab-and-go nutrition. This is a focused food service operation — grab-and-go nutrition, cold-pressed juice, smoothies, and prepared foods — not a full-service restaurant, but a meaningful revenue stream in its own right.

Neighborhood Connectivity

- **Trail users:** The Greenway-facing design invites cyclists, runners, and walkers who may not be members but engage with public spaces
- **Momentary visitors:** Art patrons from The Momentary discover the courtyard, nutrition bar, and public programming
- **8th Street Market patrons:** Food hall visitors extend their visit to include the art court, garden, or community events
- **Town Branch residents:** Walking-distance households become the core recurring membership base
- **Ice House tenants (2028+):** Adjacent office/retail workers integrate wellness into their daily routines

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Architectural Description

See `architecture-brief.md` for the detailed AI design tool brief.

Design DNA: Ozark-Nordic

A fusion of three architectural traditions: 1. **E. Fay Jones** — the Ozark master. Steep gables, local stone, timber, buildings that grow from their landscape. Thorncrown Chapel energy applied to wellness. 2. **Nordic warm minimalism** — Scandinavian sauna culture. Cedar paneling, clean lines, atmospheric lighting. Löyly Helsinki. Nordik Spa. 3. **Japanese onsen tradition** — reverence for water, stone, and transition. The bathing journey as spiritual practice.

Material Palette

- **Ozark limestone** — local, geological, connects building to landscape
- **Mass timber** — structural warmth, sustainability, biophilic
- **Cedar** — sauna tradition, aromatic, ages beautifully
- **Riverstone** — wet-area flooring, tactile connection to Ozark waterways
- **Glass** — increasing presence from bottom to top, cave-to-sky light journey
- **Steel** — preserved industrial elements from original warehouse

The Vertical Narrative

The building tells a story from bottom to top:

LEVEL	NAME	LIGHT	MATERIAL	FEELING
Underground	The Cave	Dim, atmospheric	Stone, cedar, riverstone	Grounded, internal, primal
Ground	The Foundation	Filtered natural	Timber, stone, warm	Active, engaged, communal
Upper	The Canopy	Abundant, greenhouse	Glass, plants, light timber	Airy, intellectual, creative
Rooftop	The Sky	Open sky	Landscape, garden, sky	Expansive, free, elevated

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This vision represents the synthesis of four founders' perspectives: Jordan's media and health optimization layer, Kathryn's movement and outdoor practice, Justin's contrast therapy and holistic health vision, and Chelsea's coaching and community building expertise.

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